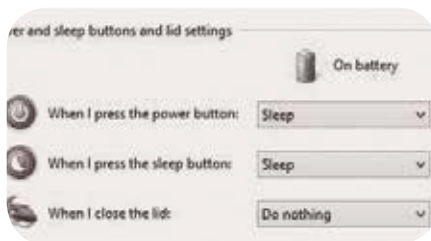


Optimising power options

Go to Control Panel > Power Options > Power Saver. Here you can decide the duration of time to dim the display, turn off the display, put the computer to sleep, adjust brightness plan when the laptop is running on battery power. Digging deeper you can go to Advanced Power settings where you can tweak even further to optimise your laptop's battery power by tweaking desktop background settings, USB settings, wireless adapter settings and much more.

Monitoring scheduled tasks

A lot of us have the habit of scheduling tasks on our desktops or laptops such as a security scanning, software updates, backups, defragmenting disks and so on. These tasks use system resources. On a desktop it wouldn't really matter as it



Tweak the Power Saver options to save on battery.

is connected to a power outlet. But on laptops, when you do not have a power outlet nearby, it can really suck up a lot of battery juice. So try and disable scheduled tasks on your laptop, when

you have no access to a power outlet anytime soon.

Avoid using external devices

When operating on battery power, avoid using USB devices, charging your mobile devices from the USB ports, external portable drives – when they are not being actively used. USB devices tend to drain your battery life and of course using the laptop battery to charge other devices is a strict no-no if you are running low yourself.

Adding more RAM

When you run out of RAM, the laptop switches to virtual memory – which is basically reading the hard drive. Using the hard drive increases the load on your laptop battery. Instead of using virtual memory to get your tasks done, it is better to add more RAM to your system as it will not only get the work done faster, but will leave the HDD free.

Use the optical drive less

The optical drive in your laptop consumes power even when you aren't playing any DVD off it. It is best to copy content from a CD/DVD onto your laptop's drive rather than playing content off a CD/DVD directly. Also ensure that there are no unwanted CDs/DVDs in your optical drive when your laptop is running off the battery as the disk spins every time Windows accesses it and drains your battery quickly. In fact disable the drive from Device Manager if you don't use it often.



Use optical drives as frugally as possible to save some battery bars

Battery maintenance

Every couple of months remove your battery from the laptop and clean its metal contacts using a clean cloth moistened with rubbing alcohol. Ensure there are no dust particles covering the contacts. Make sure that you are using a fully-charged laptop, once every two to three weeks. When you know you are not going to use your laptop for a long time, charge it to around 40-50 per cent and remove the battery from the laptop.

Precautions with laptop's air vents

Never, EVER, block the air vents of your laptop as it will heat up the components and reduce their life. Avoid using your laptop on cushioned material such as pillows or bedsheets which will block the air vents. Every once in a while, if you think you have the expertise to do so, open up your laptop and clean the air vents of any dust which may have accumulated. Use a vacuum cleaner to do this if you're afraid to open the laptop yourself, because dust



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